

§ 8. THE SOURCES.

In the book of Ch. we find many sections of S. and K. inserted almost verbatim. There is a claim further that the compiler used many other sources (see Curt. *Intr.*^{21 ff.}). It is true that some scholars, as Torrey, deny that these sources were genuine, insisting that the Chronicler pretends to quote to add plausibility to his history (ES. c. 7). Our books were originally a part of the book of Ch., and we should expect the same method to have been pursued. And our expectations are realised, for it is possible to pick out some of the sources, even though we have no parallels for control as we have in S. and K. There is not, unfortunately, much agreement among scholars as to the limits of some of these sources. There is nothing then left for me but to give my conclusions, which are, however, based on many years' study of these books. The results will be seen to be decidedly conservative.

(1) *The Memoirs of Nehemiah* = N.

Beginning with a source about the presence of which there is no difference of opinion, there is certainly incorporated in the book which bears his name some personal memoirs of Nehemiah. These are all written in the first person, and the narrative is terse and vivid. The memoirs were written for the most part soon after the close of his first administration (v. 5¹⁴), and as a historical source rank among the very best in OT. Nehemiah knew how to accomplish results, even in the face of the gravest difficulties, and he also knew how to tell what he had done without waste of words. In some places N. has somewhat the character of a diary or journal. The brief prayers and imprecations scattered through the document make the impression of a narrative originally written for the author's eye alone.

The agreement of scholars ceases, however, the moment we attempt to determine the limits of the memoirs. There is a